

VELA

YOUR *MONEY*. YOUR *JOURNEY*. YOUR *FUTURE*.

Vela explores how a digital product can simplify complex information and create a more intuitive experience for its users. The project focused on understanding the user's journey and translating it into a structured interface that feels clear, accessible and purposeful.

Role

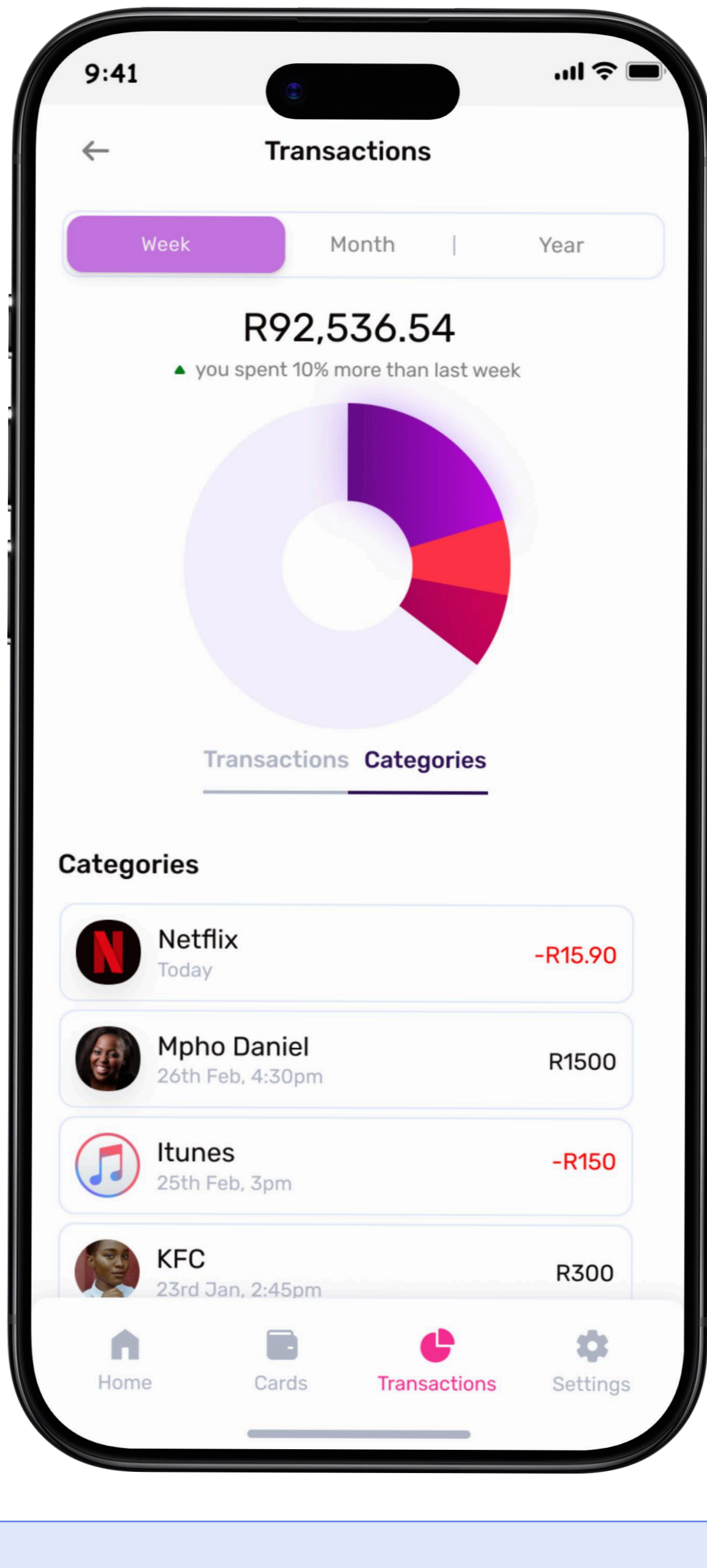
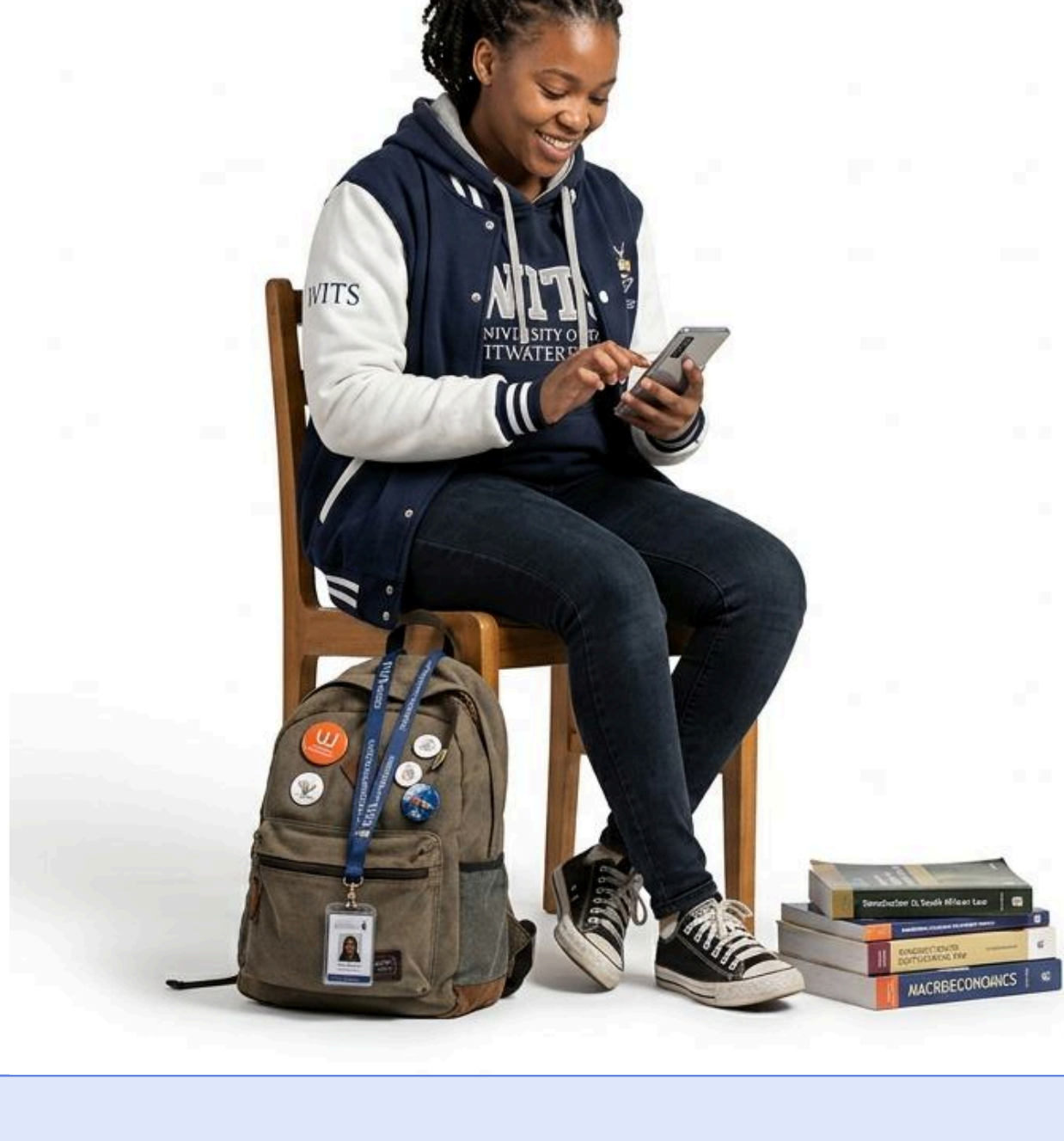
UX/UI Designer

Duration

8 Weeks

Tool

Figma



Project Overview

Vela is a banking product for tertiary students and first-time earners, designed to simplify money management and build financial confidence. It brings everyday banking, budgeting and financial education into one seamless experience.

The Design Journey

Empathize

Understand the user's needs and frustrations.

Define

Identify the key problems within the existing experience.

Ideate

Explore different ways of solving those problems.

Prototype

Create and refine the proposed interface.

Test

Validate the experience through usability feedback.

Empathy

Understanding the User Journey

The research focused on understanding how users interact with the product and where confusion or friction occurs.

Rather than designing around features alone, the process considered the complete user journey.



Define

From Complexity to Clarity

The key design challenge was to make the experience easier to understand without removing the functionality users need.

The solution focused on:

Clear information architecture

Simple navigation

Strong visual hierarchy

Consistent interactions

Clear calls to action

Ideate

User Flow (Transaction and Budgeting Journey)

Login/Sign Up

Overview

Send / Receive

Enter details

Confirm

Success

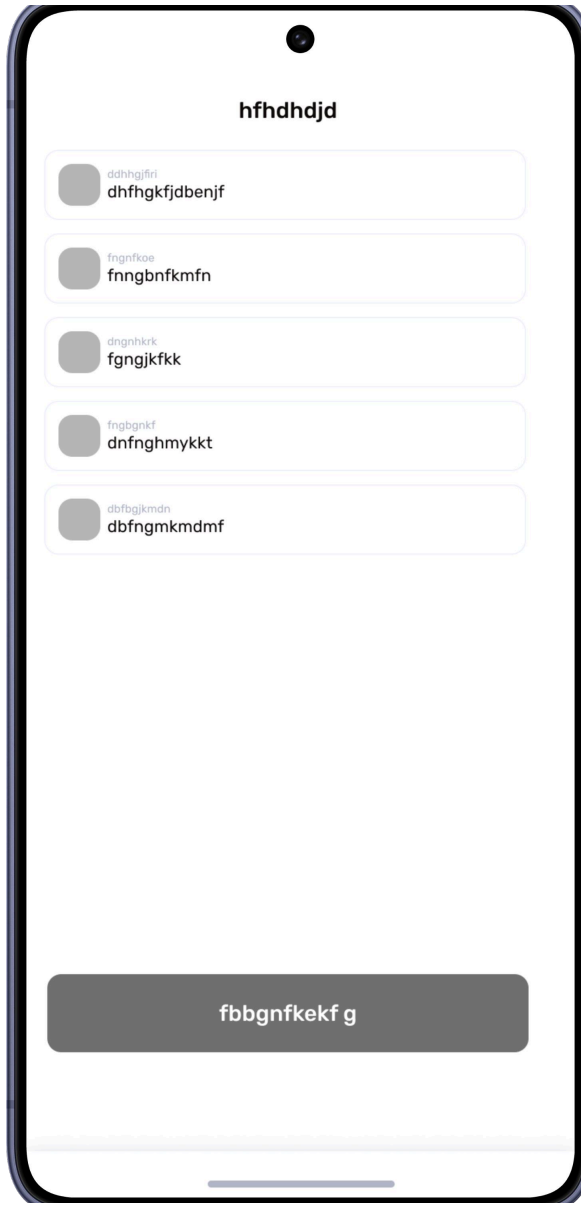
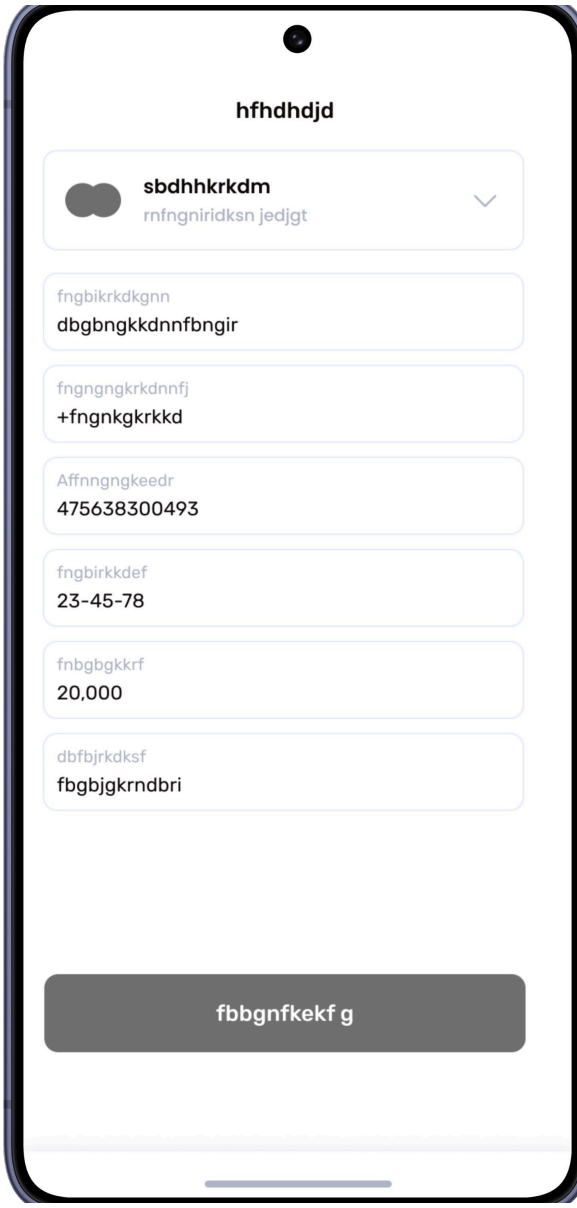
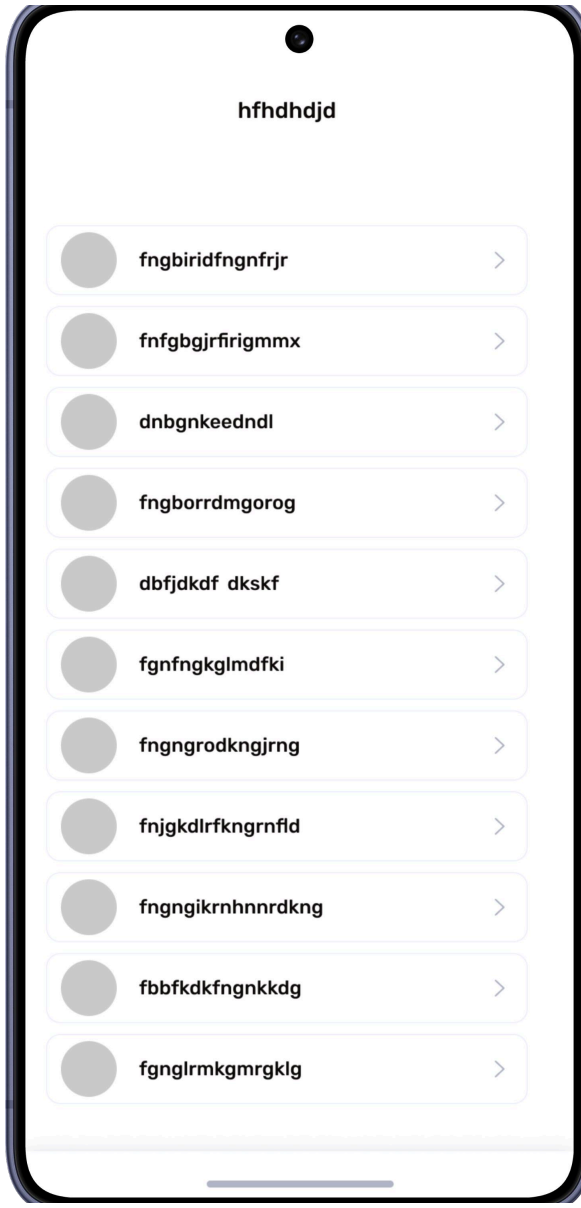
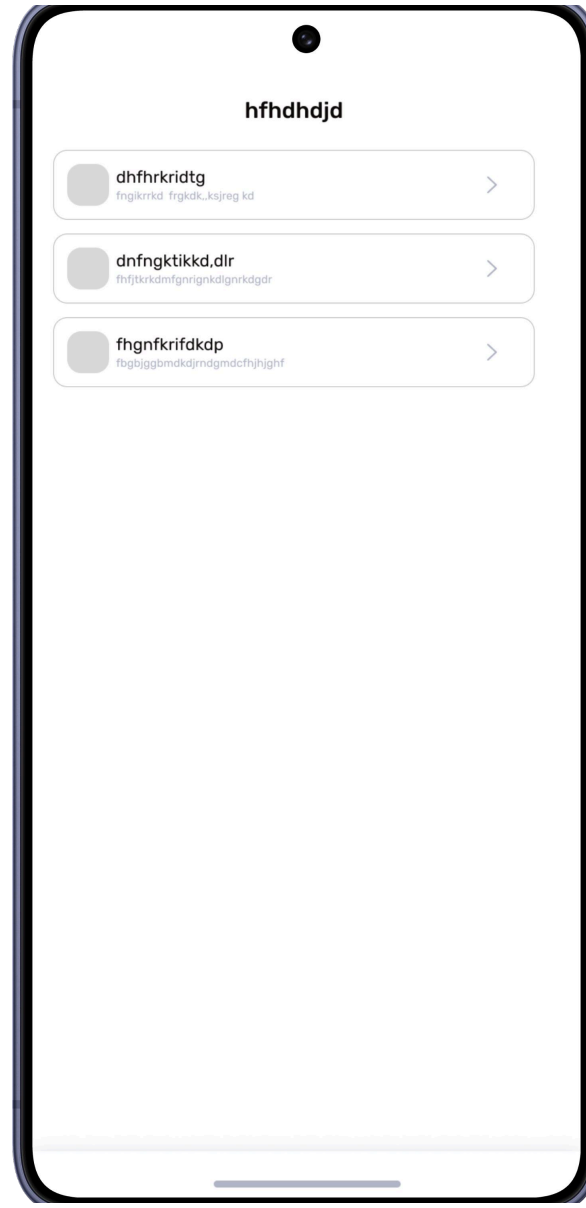
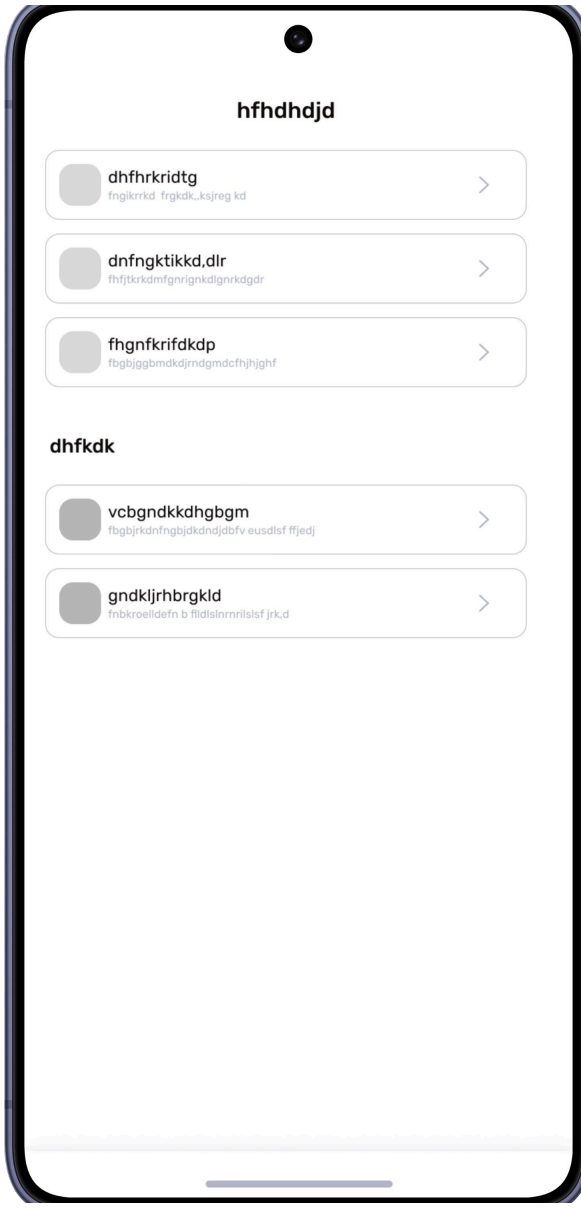
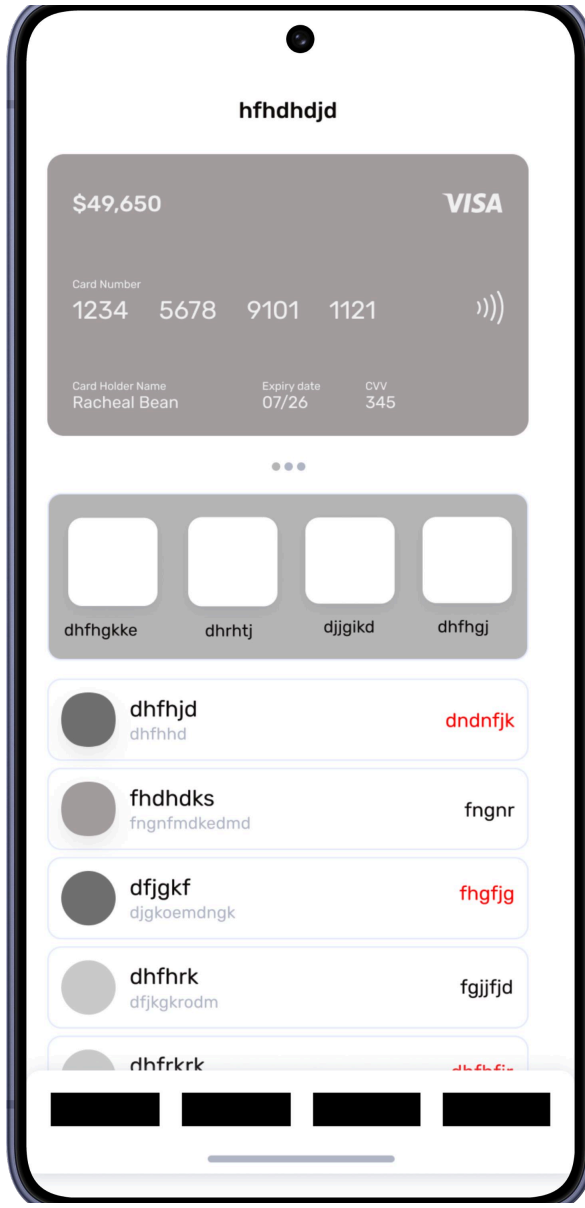
Set budget

Add card

Adjust budget

Achieve goal

Low- Fidelity Screens



Test

Usability Testing

I conducted an unmoderated study with young earners and students to understand how they navigate Vela. The goal was to identify usability issues, points of confusion, and opportunities to build financial confidence.

Unmoderated study

45 Minutes

5 Participants

Users

What users said during testing

"The overview screen is helpful, but I wasn't sure which number was my available balance."

"Setting a budget felt quick, but I wanted to see how much I'd already spent this month."

"I like seeing my goals progress, but I didn't notice when I hit a milestone."

"It's simple, clean and easy to understand."

From feedback to design

Improvement Recommendations

Improve data visualisation with clear spending charts, so users can see where their money goes at a glance instead of reading raw transaction lists.

Simplify budget setup by reducing the steps to create a first budget, so new users can start tracking spending within their first session.

Add helpful insights alongside transactions, like a comparison to last month, so users understand patterns and not just numbers.

"It's simple, clean and easy to understand." Keep the clearer CTAs and current visual hierarchy, since it's already resonating with users.

What We learned

Key Takeaways

Design for confidence, not just control. Giving users the ability to manage their money isn't enough if they can't quickly read what they're looking at. For a finance app built for first-time earners, clarity has to come before feature depth every screen needs to answer what a number means for them before it asks for a decision.